

TOOLKIT

The Partner Briefing Night-One SOP

Fill in four fields, hand this to your partner, and go into night one as a team — not two exhausted people hoping the other one holds the line, but two people with the same plan, the same words, and the same next step.

HOW TO USE THIS

This is your Partner Briefing Night-One SOP — a ready-to-fill, ready-to-print document you complete together before your first night of the Settling Sequence Reset. Work through it with your partner in one sitting (20–30 minutes is enough), print the decision tree, and put it on the nightstand. It exists for one reason: so that at 2am on night two, when one of you starts to waver, you both know exactly what to do without having to negotiate in the dark.

TEMPLATE

The Partner Briefing Template

Sit together before night one — ideally the afternoon before you start. Fill in the four fields out loud so you both hear the answers, then print or screenshot the completed version.

The Partner Briefing Template

Complete this together. Four fields. Twenty minutes. Do it before 6pm on Night One.

The Four Fields

Field 1 — Our start date

We are beginning the Settling Sequence Reset on: [DATE]

Our first full night is: [DATE — typically the following night]

Field 2 — Our 'why this, why now' statement (*read this to each other when it gets hard*)

"We are doing this because [BABY'S NAME] has been waking [NUMBER] times a night for [NUMBER] weeks/months, and we have both been

running on roughly [NUMBER] hours of broken sleep. We want her to fall asleep in her cot on her own so that [YOUR SPECIFIC REASON — e.g. 'I can go back to work without being a danger on the road' / 'we can stop dreading every bedtime' / 'I stop feeling like I'm failing her every night']. That is worth a hard few nights."

Field 3 — Our agreed response window

During the Settling Sequence Reset, when [BABY'S NAME] cries in the cot, we will wait [NUMBER — from your programme module] minutes before going in.

The person who goes in first on odd nights is: [NAME]

The person who goes in first on even nights is: [NAME]

(Alternating prevents one person carrying all the weight and all the doubt.)

Field 4 — Our one agreed rule for talking about it at night

Between 9pm and 6am, we will not debate whether to abandon the plan. If one of us wants to change course, we agree to: [CHOOSE ONE: 'wait until morning and talk about it then' / 'say the code word below and the other person reads the Hold-The-Line script']

Our code word for 'I'm struggling but I don't want to give up': [WORD — e.g. 'anchor', 'steady', 'hold']

Sign-off: We have both read this. We both understand what the next three nights will ask of us. We are going in as a team.

[YOUR NAME] _____ Date: _____

[PARTNER'S NAME] _____ Date: _____

The 2am Decision Tree — Three Overnight Flashpoints

Print this single page and put it on the nightstand or tape it to the inside of the nursery door before night one. Use it in the moment — you do not have to think, just follow the branch.

The 2am Decision Tree

Three Overnight Flashpoints — Follow the Branch, Don't Improvise

Print this. Put it on the nightstand. Use it instead of your brain at 2am.

FLASHPOINT 1 — "[BABY'S NAME] HAS BEEN CRYING FOR LONGER THAN OUR AGREED WINDOW AND IT'S ESCALATING"

Is she at a full crying pitch with no pause?

- YES → One person goes in (the assigned person for tonight — see Field 3). Use the settling sequence check-in from your programme module. Do not pick up unless the safety check below triggers. Return to the door. Reset the timer.
- NO (fussing / grizzling with pauses) → Stay out. Grizzling with pauses is her practising. This is the process working. Wait the full window.

Safety check before picking up: Is she showing any of these — fever above 38°C, vomiting, unusual high-pitched cry unlike her normal protest cry, visible distress beyond hunger/tiredness?

- YES → Pick up, check, respond to the need. This is not a plan failure. Note the time and restart the sequence tomorrow.
 - NO → Hold the window. Use the Hold-The-Line script if your partner is wavering.
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FLASHPOINT 2 — "IT'S BEEN 40 MINUTES AND NOTHING IS WORKING AND ONE OF US WANTS TO FEED HER TO SLEEP JUST THIS ONCE"

Has she had a feed in the last [NUMBER — from your programme] hours?

- YES → A feed now is a sleep association reinforcement, not a hunger response. This is the exact moment the plan asks you to hold. Say the code word. Read the Hold-The-Line script together.
- NO (it has genuinely been longer) → A brief, lights-off, no-eye-contact feed is acceptable. Feed, wind, put back in the cot awake. Do not rock to sleep after. Note it in your log so you can see the pattern shift over the week.

The 'just this once' rule: There is no 'just this once' on nights one through three. The baby does not know it's an exception. Your nervous system does not know it's an exception. Hold the window.

FLASHPOINT 3 — "MY PARTNER SAID THEY'D STOP ROCKING HER AND I CAN HEAR THEM ROCKING HER"

Step 1: Do not go in and correct them in the moment. Correction at 2am creates a fight, not a fix.

Step 2: Say the code word through the door or send a one-word text: [YOUR CODE WORD]

Step 3: If they come out, read the Hold-The-Line script together — it takes 90 seconds.

Step 4: Debrief in the morning using the Morning-After Check-In (Tool 4 in this SOP). Adjust if needed. Keep going.

The rule: One misaligned response on one night does not break the reset. Chronic inconsistency does. One moment at a time.

The Hold-The-Line Script

Read this out loud to your partner — or have them read it to you — when one of you is about to fold. It takes 90 seconds. Use the code word from Field 4 as the trigger to pull it out.

The Hold-The-Line Script

Read aloud when one of you wants to give up. 90 seconds. That's all this takes.

The person who is steady reads this to the person who is wavering.

(If you're both wavering, take turns. First sentence each.)

"Hey. I know this is really hard right now. I can hear it too.

This is the moment the plan warned us about. It told us that on night [ONE / TWO / THREE], there would be a point where every part of us would say 'just go in, just feed her, just do what works.' It said this would happen. This is that moment.

[BABY'S NAME] is not in danger. She is not sick. She is learning something she has never been asked to learn before — how to fall asleep without us doing it for her. That is genuinely hard for her, and it's genuinely hard for us to listen to.

But here is what we know: if we go in right now and do the thing that stops the crying tonight, we are back here tomorrow night, and the night after, and every night for [WEEKS / MONTHS] more. She does not get better at this on her own. She gets better at this because we gave her the space to practise.

We agreed to this. We signed this sheet. Our reason was: [READ YOUR FIELD 2 'WHY THIS, WHY NOW' STATEMENT ALOUD].

That reason hasn't changed in the last forty minutes. The only thing that's changed is that we're tired and it's [TIME].

We don't have to make a decision right now. We just have to wait [NUMBER] more minutes. Can you give me [NUMBER] more minutes?"

Then: Set a timer together. Do not go back in until it goes off. Stand in the hallway together if you need to. Hold hands if that helps. But hold the line.

If the timer goes off and she is still crying: Reset. Read the decision tree. Take the next branch. You are still in the process — this is not a failure, this is night one.

WORKSHEET

The Morning-After Check-In

Fill this in together the morning after each of the first three nights — takes five minutes over coffee. It keeps you aligned, surfaces what to adjust, and helps you see progress even when it doesn't feel like progress yet.

The Morning-After Check-In

Complete together each morning of the first three days. Five minutes. Over coffee if possible.

NIGHT [1 / 2 / 3] — DATE: [DATE]

1. What actually happened last night (facts only, no judgement):

- [BABY'S NAME] went into the cot at: [TIME]
- She fell asleep at (estimate): [TIME]

- She woke at: [TIME/S]
 - We went in: [NUMBER] times
 - We fed her: [YES / NO] — at [TIME] if yes
 - She was asleep again by (estimate): [TIME]
 - First wake-up of the day: [TIME]
 - Total night wakings compared to last week: **MORE / SAME / FEWER**
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2. One moment that was harder than expected:

[WRITE IT DOWN — one sentence. Getting it out of your head stops it becoming a story you replay.]

3. One moment that showed the process working (even a small one):

[e.g. 'She grizzled for four minutes and then went quiet on her own.' / 'She settled in eight minutes instead of twenty.' / 'I held the window and it worked.']

[WRITE IT HERE]

4. Were we aligned last night?

- We stayed consistent with the plan: **YES / MOSTLY / NO**
- If no or mostly: what specifically broke down?

[ONE SENTENCE]

- What we will do differently tonight:

[ONE SPECIFIC CHANGE — e.g. 'I'll say the code word earlier, before I'm desperate' / 'We'll swap who goes in at the second waking' / 'I'll re-read the Hold-The-Line script before bed so it's fresh']

5. Quick calibration — circle one for each:

	ME	PARTNER
Confidence in the plan this morning	1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5	1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5
Trust that it's working	1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5	1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5
Readiness to go again tonight	1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5	1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 5

If either score is 2 or below: Post in the programme community or bring it to your next check-in call before tonight. A low score you ignore becomes a broken plan at midnight.

Tonight's plan is: the same / [SPECIFIC ADJUSTMENT — one thing only]

***Reminder:** Progress in the Settling Sequence Reset is not always linear on the scoreboard. A harder night two after an easier night one is normal — it is called the extinction burst and your programme module covers it. Look at the trend across the three nights, not the single data point in front of you.*

YOUR NEXT STEP

Your Next Move Inside Sleep Reset for New Parents

You have the briefing structure — now go build the actual settling sequence you'll be briefing your partner on. Head into the programme and open the Settling Sequence Reset module. That's where you'll find your personalised response window timing, your specific check-in steps for going into the room, and the exact sequence you'll reference in your decision tree. Complete that module before you sit down to fill in the Partner Briefing Template — ideally the afternoon before your first night.

Open the Settling Sequence Reset Module